Courses of Menu-South Indian

Rice with sambar

Rice with rasam

Curd with rice (served with poriyal / kootu, pickle)

Palpayasam

Betel leaf and nut

i. Tamil Nadu Cuisine

Characteristic Features

Variety of raw and parboiled rice as a staple food, forms part of a typical meal in Tamilnadu, accompanied with mildly or richly spiced vegetarian and non-vegetarian dishes.

- The various Tamil dishes can be categorized in different groups starting from the regular meals, the light meals, snacks and desserts.
- Mashed dhal with ghee, sambar, pulikuzhambu, rasam, kootu, kolisaaru, morkuzhambu and milagukuzhambu are the special dishes of Tamil Nadu.
- This cuisines conventionally include all the six tastes that any food categorized into sweet, sour, salt, pungent, bitter and astringent into the main meal so as to get complete nutrition and balanced digestion.

In Tamil Nadu there are different types of cuisines like Chettinad and Kongu. Some special foods like Thirunelveli halwa, Kumbakonam degree filter coffee, Ambur biriyani, Kanjeepuram idly, and Madurai Jigarthanda are also famous in Tamilnadu cuisine.



▲ Plate 7.13 Tamil Nadu Cuisine

For example Traditional meals served in Chettinad style on banana leaves follow a specific protocol. Each dish has a designated space and order in which, it has to be served.

DO YOU KNOW?

Nanjil Nadu is famous for its abundant use of coconut oil and coconut dishes made in Kanyakumari district.

Courses of Menu

Tamil Nadu

Items served at the top of the leaf

Salt, pickle, mormilagai, varuval, poriyal, kootu, lentil ball urundai, masiyal, banana.

Items served at bottom left

Appalam, fritters and fries.

Items served in the centre

Rice and ghee with mashed dhal, sambar, pulikuzhambu, morkuzhambu, rasam, curd.

Items served at bottom right

Sweet dishes like ukkarai, palpayasam.

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